

This is what one of my friend told me about open source contribution when I asked him for the first time. “It is like a cake open for everyone. Anyone can take it, modify it, improve it, redistribute it. Best part? It’s completely free!”

Todo : A very big cake and people around it, AI generated image

Great softwares and platforms like Linux, Wordpress, VSCode, etc all are open-source, being built, maintained & used by millions of people across the world.

Introduction

‘Open source’ software is software with source code that anyone can inspect, modify, and enhance.

So, why should one do Open Source?

1. **Enhances Your Skills** : Doing contributions helps you understand the platform you are working for, improves your ability to understand new piece of code and contribute to it, enhances your team working ability, ultimately making you a great developer.
2. **Improve Network** : Open Source is a very big welcoming community. Once you start contributing to it, you'll start building a network which will bring more value than your net worth!
3. **More Opportunities** : Working on open source and contributing will land you in tons of opportunities and is a big green flag to recruiters while showing up for job interviews.
4. **Mentorship** : Thanks to the vast community of open source, contributing to projects will help you land a great mentorship for your professional career.

Misconception

It's often mis-understood that open source contribution is something that has to do only with code. No. That's not the case. You can contribute to literally anything, it can be a UI design, or developer documentation, community management, or writing test cases. Literally anything that can help build a better project!

First Contribution

Doing your first open source contribution is not so difficult. It just has one step involved and that is to START.

Starting Point

Open Source contribution mainly relies on co-working where multiple people help to develop a single project. Hence, Git is something you'd widely hear about. Here are the resources to start learning Git.

1. Git Tutorial : [Link](#)

2. Git Documentation : [Link](#)

3. Git CheatSheet : [Link](#)

Pro Tip : Create a dummy project using Git, create 2–3 branches, experiment multiple git commands to learn hands-on

Finding First Project

There's a whole big community of people who are helping out first time contributors to start with and here's a good place to find your first project to start with : <https://firstcontributions.github.io>

Explore this page, find any interesting project that you wish to work with and boom, you've officially decided to start with your FIRST OPEN CONTRIBUTION! 🙌

How to?

Now that you've found your first project, let's break down how to do that contribution!

Issues

Issues are like the bugs reported by people in that project and if you wish to take up any of them, you can simply comment on the issue and wait for project-maintainer to assign it to you!

Fork

Once you are assigned for that issue, you can now fork the project in Github. Forking is like creating a copy of the project into your profile. Don't worry, it's allowed and that's open-source for you!

Clone

You can also clone the project to work on it in your local system.

Cloning is like downloading the code on your system!

Branch

Once you are all set, create a new branch for the issue you are working with and start making the changes without affecting others code. This is where you'll solve the issue you've picked

Pull Request

Once the changes are done and you've tested it out and make sure everything is working fine, you can raise a PR (Pull Request) to the organisers. PR is like a request to organisers to accept the code changes you've made to solve the issue.

See you, the person who made the **FIRSTTT CONTRIBUTIONNN**



Resources

Here are some of the out of the box resources that can help you take your open source journey to next level!

Events & Hackathons

There are many organisations who host open source events to promote this culture and here's a list of top events you can checkout:

1. HacktoberFest
2. Gsoc (Google summer of code)
3. Outreachy
4. MLH Fellowship
5. GsoD (google season of docs)
6. Open Summer of Code
7. Gssoc (Girlscript summer of code)
8. Rails Girls Summer of code

You can checkout more of these events here : [Link](#)

Websites to find best Open Source Projects

1. <https://www.codetriage.com/>
2. <https://firstcontributions.github.io>
3. <https://gauger.io/contrib/#/language/javascript>
4. <https://up-for-grabs.net/#/>
5. <https://ovio.org/>
6. <https://codetribute.mozilla.org/>
7. <https://goodfirstissue.dev/>

Wanna know more?

Here's a complete guide for open source : [Link](#)

Also checkout this open source handbook : [Link](#)

Trending Projects on Github : [Link](#)

Also checkout [INDIA FOSS](#) community, if you want to organize and participate in free and open source software, hardware, and open data conferences in India, [Swecha](#) community, based in telangana to contribute more on Open Source Projects